

lly to GitLab Team Members using this link, as are our weekly meeting notes.

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## SECTION: marketing/team-member-social-media-policy.md

## Introduction

We recognize that many team members engage in social media activity. This policy establishes a set of rules and guidelines for any activity and participation on social media channels when commenting about GitLab or GitLab-related topics.

These rules are intended to be adaptable to the changes in technology and norms of online communication and behavior and may be amended by GitLab at any time, for any reason, without notice to team members. However, we will work to be as transparent as possible when communicating changes, what those changes are, and when they are expected to go into effect.

This policy also applies to social media activity when on or off duty, while using the Company's or personal electronic resources, and whether the team member posts anonymously or using a pseudonym.

Be diligent, and if it's questionable, don't say it. You are personally responsible for the social posts, likes and shares, and replies you post on social media while representing GitLab. Everything you publish is publicly viewable and will be available for a long time, even if redacted. Remember that you represent GitLab and our culture. When commenting on posts, please keep in mind: "Don't argue but represent".

## Social Media Policy for Team Members

You'll be asked to confirm reading this section during your onboarding to the company. We'll ask everyone to review and sign off on review in partnership with legal for existing employees.

If you've been identified as a spokesperson for the company or a specific function within GitLab, you may have unique circumstances. Please refer to your team guidelines or the communications team for more information about your work as a spokesperson and the social media policy.

## Definition of social media

The GitLab Social Media policy for team members applies to traditional social media channels, like Twitter, LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram, as well as "social-like" sites, like YouTube, HackerNews, Reddit, blogs (on the GitLab website, Medium, or any other online journals or diaries), message boards, forums (including the GitLab Forum, private groups or forums on public sites like Facebook Groups), and private/direct messages on public social media channels (Twitter DMS, Instagram Directs, etc.).

The term "social media" applies to any online technology in use now or in the future that enables you to send or receive information and communicate or interact with others. Any site where you can share a post or comment on a post would be considered a social media website for the purposes of this policy.

## Exclusions for anonymous review sites

This policy is not intended to limit team members from sharing their feedback or reviews of their experiences at GitLab on sites like Glassdoor, Fishbowl, Indeed, or similar sites. While we encourage you to share feedback with your manager and the people ops team, we celebrate our value of transparency and welcome feedback from team members on these sites, as long as the feedback follows our SAFE Framework.

All other GitLab codes of conduct and policies also apply to our social media policy

Please adhere to the Community Code of Conduct, Anti-Harrassment Policy, which includes sexual harrassment and discrimination policies, and our Code of Business Conduct and Ethics. These policies all apply to team member behavior within social media and in public online spaces.

Social Media sometimes generates press and media attention or legal questions

Please refer all inquires to the Communications Team in the external-comms Slack channel

What you should do

Click each recommendation below for more details

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Do disclose that you're a team member

</summary>

If you talk about work-related matters within your job responsibility area, you must disclose your affiliation with GitLab. If you have a vested interest in something you're posting on social, point it out. You can identify yourself as a team member in your profile bio, list GitLab as your employer, or mention that you're a team member in the post itself. You can also add LifeAtGitLab to the end of your social posts about GitLab-related topics. How you choose to disclose is up to you.

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Do state that it's your opinion

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When commenting **on** the business, you're not commenting **for** the business. Unless authorized to speak on behalf of GitLab and through comms training. However, don't add your opinion to content from a news source that includes financial figures or forecasts. If you would like to share content that includes financial figures or a forecast, please only share it without adding your commentary. Not sure if you should share? Ask in the safe Slack channel.

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<summary markdown='span'>

Do protect yourself

</summary>

Consider what information you're sharing online and how it can be used to identify you.

Everyone has a different level of privacy they want to abide by, have you thought about yours? Some of the things folks opt-out of to protect their privacy include: not tagging specific locations in posts while you're still on-site, not including phone numbers or email addresses in plain text because bots sweep for contact info, and not showing the faces of their children on public channels. You aren't required to follow any of these specifics, but consider what kind of information will be available to the public when publishing on your social media profiles.

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Do act responsibly and ethically

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Don't misrepresent yourself. If you're not a director in your role, don't say you are. Don't imply that you're a member of a team if you're not. Share your thoughts, but disclose your role. Furthermore, [our team members are bound by the same code of conduct we provide to the community](https://about.gitlab.com/community/contribute/code-of-conduct/).

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Do try to live our values

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Easier said than done, but consider our values when engaging online. The same space and respect we grant each other is needed with strangers on social media.

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<summary markdown='span'>

Do share GitLab content that is already published

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If it's written in a blog, presented at a public conference, or simply on GitLab's website, it's publicly available to share on social media. GitLab's social media advocacy tool will have a lot of preapproved content, including links, images, and copy, available to all team members. Anything already in the public domain, posted in the newswire Slack channel, or in the company social media advocacy tool can and should be shared freely. Some items in the newswire Slack channel may say "shareable internal only", so please do not share those stories on social media.

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Examples of what you should, and are encouraged, to share on social media

- GitLab blogs and press releases
- Positive news media that mentions GitLab and is shared in the newswire Slack channel (team member adds no commentary/copy to the post) or is available to share in the social media advocacy tool (with commentary/copy to share)
- Industry reports that are publicly available and are ungated
- Videos from either our brand or Unfiltered YouTube Channels
- Third-party articles that don't bash competitors (mentioning them or comparing GitLab and competitors is fine)

- Retweeting or sharing GitLab brand social channel posts from Twitter, LinkedIn, Facebook, or Instagram
- All of the above from our eco and alliance partners
- Items that are not connected to your job or GitLab at all! Social Media is best when you bring your true-self to the mix. DevOps isn't the only thing you're interested in, so consider posting about other passions and topics.

Learn more about what is encouraged and how GitLab helps to enable you to become great at using social media on our team member advocacy page.

It's your job to protect GitLab, our customers, and our team members

Whether you're an intern or our CEO, protecting the GitLab brand, the company, and our entire team is a part of your job description.

You can protect GitLab by not sharing the following data with the public on your social media profiles

Click each recommendation below for more details

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Don't speculate or add forward-looking statements

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<ul>

<li>Forward-looking statements predict, project, or use future events as expectations or possibilities. Team Members mustn't speculate or add forward-looking statements to their opinions written on social media. Forward-looking statements could include company valuation, details on customer volume, subscription growth, and more. This would include forecasting, or when data is presented to argue for or against future trends. Sometimes an article from a news source will use speculative information in their story. While this is okay to share, it is not okay to share your commentary with speculative information. Not sure if it's public? Ask in the safe Slack channel or <a href="https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/legal/safe-framework/">review the SAFE handbook page</a>.</li>

<li><b>Some language indicators that you're talking about forward-looking statements would be using one of the following words: "will," "may," "should," "expects," "intends," "plans," "aims," "anticipates," "believes," "estimates," "predicts," "potential," "looking to," or "continue,".</b></li>

</ul>

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<summary markdown='span'>

Don't share customer or Team Member personal information

</summary>

Team Members are prohibited from using social media to post or display comments about co-workers or supervisors/managers of GitLab that are knowingly false, vulgar, obscene,

threatening, intimidating, disparages GitLab's products or services, depicts the team member engaging in conduct that is unlawful or in violation of GitLab's workplace policies against workplace violence or discrimination and harassment based on any protected status under federal, state or local law. Allow the team member(s) to own the decision on what is and isn't public about them.

For customers, any customer with a published case study is available to share publicly. If you would like to share information about a customer please reach out to the customer reference team first before sharing any content on social media.

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<summary markdown='span'>

Don't bash competitors

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While sharing your opinion is a critical part of being authentic on social media, it's equally important to limit overly negative responses to competitor posts. We don't like trolls, and neither do our competitors. Providing constructive feedback is read very differently than trolling. Trolling occurs when you respond to social media posts with intentionally provocative or offensive messages.

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<summary markdown='span'>

Don't share legal information

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Never share anything to do with a legal issue, legal case, or attorneys without first checking with legal in the legal Slack channel. Note, that if you're looking to connect on whether or not you should publicly disclose legal issues, the answer is probably a no.

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<summary markdown='span'>

Don't share confidential information

</summary>

<ul>

<li>Don't share information that is considered personal or GitLab proprietary confidential. If it's related to work in an issue, consider reviewing whether or not the issue was made confidential. It is inappropriate to use or disclose confidential personal information about another individual or use or disclose GitLab's proprietary confidential information in any form of social media.</li>

<li>Confidential personal information refers to information that could be used to commit identity theft such as an individual's Social Security Number, financial account numbers, driver's license number or personal medical information (including family medical history).</li>

<li>GitLab's proprietary confidential information refers to internal information regarding GitLab's finances, future business performance and business plans, business and brand

strategies and information which is or relates to GitLab's trade secrets.</li>  
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<summary markdown='span'>

Don't use third-party materials (including images, videos, or text) without permission from the owner

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<ul>

<li>Images, videos, and text, even if posted publicly on the internet, are copyright-protected materials and should not be used without the permission of the owner.</li>

<li>If you're unable to obtain permission from the owner, hyperlink to the relevant material rather than copying it.</li>

<li>Consider using a source of permissively-licensed images, like <a href="https://unsplash.com/">unsplash.com</a>, which provides free to use materials which <a href="https://unsplash.com/license">do not require attribution</a>.</li>

<li>You can (and are encouraged to)share GitLab-made assets even if these contain third-party materials</li>

<li>If you're unsure what's permissible, reach out to the legal Slack channel.</li>  
</ul>

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<summary markdown='span'>

Don't create images with, or manipulate, third-party logos without the permission of the owner

</summary>

<ul>

<li>Logos (including those indicating companies, and products and services) are registered trademarks. You must obtain the consent of the owner before using, for any purpose, any third-party logo.</li>

<li>If you're wanting to share content from GitLab's website or social channels and it has logos or trademarks from other companies, this is okay to use. The various marketing teams at GitLab are responsible for confirming the company's use of these logos and trademarks and sharing links or images that GitLab produced does not violate this policy.</li>

<li>You can refer to other companies, or products and services, by name (without using a logo) provided that (i) the company, product or service in question could not easily be identified without using its name; and (ii) your use does not imply endorsement by, or affiliation with, the trademark owner.</li>

<li>You can (and are encouraged to)share GitLab-made assets even if these contain third-party

logos</li>

<li>If you're unsure what's permissible, reach out to the legal Slack channel.</li>  
</ul>

</details>

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<summary markdown='span'>

Don't use social media, blogs, or other digital channels for GitLab-related communications with other team members

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<ul>

<li>While GitLab is a transparent company, we like to keep negative feedback 1:1. Team members should not discuss work-related situations in public forums. For all communications that can be public-facing, please use issues and epics and mark them as not confidential.</li>

</ul>

</details>

## Connecting with Team Members on Social Media

In case you want to connect with fellow team members of GitLab on social media, you have to keep it professional. With this communication, we would like you to consider GitLab's Communication Guidelines at all times. Aligned with our Anti-Harassment Policy, it is expected that everyone will contribute to an inclusive and collaborative working environment and respect each other at all times.

## Mimicking the GitLab brand

Keep your identity clear on social media channels by not using the GitLab logo as your profile image, not adding GitLab to your @handle, and not adding the company name to your display names.

Upon first glance of your social media profile, there should be immense clarity that you are a team member of GitLab and not GitLab the company. Use common sense when selecting pictures and names to use. We'll always work to get profile names and visuals updated to reflect who runs the account. If the corporate marketing team comes across profiles that don't respond to these requests, we will report them for impersonating our brand.

## Unauthorized GitLab brand social media accounts

As a Team Member of GitLab, you aren't authorized to create company/brand social media profiles to use for your work. If promoting content should come from the company, you'll need to open a request issue with the organic social team. If the corporate marketing team encounters unauthorized profiles, they will be treated as external threats and reported for impersonation. There is no formal method for requesting new brand channels, nor is there an outline for managing to do so. It's best to use personally identified social media profiles to share your posts.

## Contests or sweepstakes on your social media profiles

As part of your role at GitLab, you may be responsible for a contest or a sweepstakes with social media elements. It's important to follow legal guidelines. Essentially, as a representative of GitLab, if you're promoting the contest on your social media channels, it will need to follow the same rules as what the GitLab brand channels will need to follow. You can learn more about legal and contests in the handbook [here](#).

## Follow website terms of use

Most social media websites/services have rules concerning the use of and activity conducted on their sites. These are sometimes referred to as "Terms of Use." Team Members must follow the established terms and conditions of use that have been established by the website, social media network, or channel and not do anything that would violate those rules.

## Ramifications of not following the social media policy

If the company finds any statements or claims that are false or misleading, or we discover an activity that does not follow the policy, we will contact you to correct the situation.

If you are consistently disregarding the social media policy, especially if you fail to disclose your relationship to GitLab, make false or misleading statements about GitLab or our products and services, GitLab retains the right to discipline, up to termination of employment with anyone that does not comply with this policy.

## Conflicts with local laws

In the event there is any conflict between this social media policy and local laws and/or regulations for your region, the local laws and/or regulations prevail over our policy and must be followed. However, if the conflict is simply because of practice or customs varying between regions, our social media policy must still be followed.

Any conduct which is impermissible under the law if expressed in any other form or forum is also impermissible if expressed through social media.

See section below for location-specific details that are necessary to review.

## Location-specific social media policy details

### United States

Confidential proprietary information does not include information lawfully acquired by non-management employees about wages, hours or other terms and conditions of employment, if used for purposes protected by Section 7 of the National Labor Relations Act such as joining or forming a union, engaging in collective bargaining, or engaging in other concerted activity for their mutual aid or protection.

GitLab will not enforce the social media policy in a manner that would interfere with team members' rights under the National Labor Relations Act to discuss the terms and conditions of employment.



United Kingdom

You may not use data obtained in the course of your employment with GitLab in any way which breaches the provisions of the Data Protection Act 1998.

Transform this policy into action with a social media training and certification

Take this policy and turn it into a social media certification in less than 45 minutes with the social media 101 training and certification. You'll find details on the training and what to expect [here](#).

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## SECTION: marketing/use-cases.md

## Core DevOps Solution Definition

A DevOps solution is:

- A customer problem or initiative that needs a solution and attracts budget
- Defined in customer terms
- Often aligned to industry analyst market coverage (i.e. Gartner, Forrester, etc. write reports on the topic)
- Relatively stable over time.
- Aligned to value plays and revenue programs

These are discrete problems that we believe GitLab solves and are reasons customers choose GitLab (hence which we should seek out in prospects). More information on how GitLab uses solutions can be found on the [Solutions Go-to-market](#) page

## Core DevOps Solutions go-to-market motions

### 1. DevOps Platform

#### 1. DevOps Platform

Business objectives: We want to achieve expected results of DevOps by resolving siloed teams, lack of visibility and collaboration which inhibits my speed of delivery. - (DevOps Platform)  
I want to manage my entire DevOps lifecycle more efficiently with better outcomes. The number of tools and maintenance of integrations is overwhelming and costly and security is challenging to integrate. My processes may include planning to production or may be a segment of the SDLC. (GitLab examples: Epics, Issue Boards, Source Code Management, CI, CD, Security Scans and Monitoring from GitLab. Value Stream Management: (VSM) helps you visualize and manage the flow of new innovation from ideas to customers. In GitLab, cycle analytics is a key element of managing the value stream.)

Analyst Coverage: Value Stream Delivery Platform report

Value Drivers:

1. Increase Operational Efficiencies: consistent and efficient dev experience with single source of truth and simplified tool chain

1. Deliver Better Products Faster: More collaboration, working in parallel

1. Reduce Security and Compliance Risk: standardized pipelines for consistent testing, end-to-end common controls, and shared views for visibility across functions.

## 2. Software Delivery Automation

Business objectives: We want to increase the quality of my code while decreasing time to delivery.

We need to automate the build and testing processes to consistently integrate code and continuously test. We want to run the unit and integration tests, measure performance and automate manual QA processes. We may use GitLab SCM or another. (Example capabilities in GitLab include Pipeline, CI Runner, Jobs, Scheduled Jobs, Testing, Security Scanning (SAST), and Code Quality). We also want to speed up the build and release process and empower our developers to automatically deploy code. This requires that we automate the build, test and packaging, configuration and deployment of applications to a target environment. (Example capabilities in GitLab include: Container Registry, Deploy Boards, Canary Deploys, Partial Deploys, Manual Deploys, Environments.)

Analyst Coverage: Forrester CI and Forrester Cloud CI, Gartner ARO, Forrester CDRA

Value Drivers:

1. Increase Operational Efficiencies: Single source of truth between SCM and CI; consistent and efficient dev experience. Scalable, self-service, reusable deployment template. Deploy anywhere.

1. Deliver Better Products Faster: Automatically deploy and test application with early feedback.

1. Reduce Security and Compliance Risk: Enforce common controls and scan for vulnerabilities at the point of code change.

## 3. Continuous Software Security Assurance

Continuous Software Security Assurance

Aligns to what was DevSecOps (aka Shift Left Security)

Business objectives: We want to test for application security vulnerabilities early in our app dev lifecycle.

We need to identify vulnerabilities during development with actionable information to empower developers to remediate vulnerabilities earlier in the life cycle. (In GitLab, SAST, DAST, Dependency Scanning, and Container Scanning, etc.)

Analyst Coverage: Forrester SCA Wave, Gartner Application Security MQ

Value Drivers:

1. Increase Operational Efficiencies: Fix vulnerabilities at point of code change to reduce rework

1. Deliver Better Products Faster: Ability to start testing early in dev process to eliminate vulnerabilities at the source

1. Reduce Security and Compliance Risk: Fix vulnerabilities with actionable feedback to the developer at point of code change. Auto remediate when possible.

4. Continuous Software Compliance

4. Continuous Software Compliance

Business objectives: We want to reduce risk by ensuring pipelines are compliant with common controls and popular industry regulations.

We need to enforce standardized CI pipelines that include requisite testing and then ensure common compliance controls are followed (such as separation of duties).

Analyst coverage: none yet

Value Drivers:

1. Reduce security and compliance risk: standardization and policy enforcement

1. Increase operational efficiencies: simplified audits

1. Deliver better products faster: find compliance flaws earlier in the SDLC to avoid impacting time to market

Wedge conversation topics

These are topics where sales and marketing conversations may start, but then we want to lead the prospect toward delivery automation. For instance, GitOps is hot topic and ranking well in SEO so it's worth talking about. But ultimately we want to drive people to delivery automation (or platform).

1. GitOps

1. GitOps

We are looking for a way to automatically provision, administer and maintain infrastructure as code. - (CI/CD Infrastructure-as-code or GitOps)

I manually stage and test environments for infrastructure making it hard to track and error-prone. I want to stage all components and test them to be sure it works to automate my release pipelines, provide consistency, reduce cost, and eliminate errors. I may frequently leverage integration with Terraform, Kubernetes, Ansible, OpenStack and others.

Analyst Coverage: TBD

Value Drivers:

1. Increase Operational Efficiencies: consistent dev experience, reusable scripts for operations

1. Deliver Better Products Faster: developer self-service, reusable CI/CD templates

1. Reduce Security and Compliance Risk: enforces common controls

This conversation should lead the prospect toward the Delivery Automation solution.

## 2. Source Code Management (aka Version Control and Collaboration, VC&C)

## 2. Source Code Management (aka Version Control and Collaboration, VC&C)

We are looking for a way to create, manage and protect our intellectual property (i.e. source code, design, images, etc). - In simple terms Version Control and Collaboration (VC&C), but more inclusively, product configuration management or product asset management.

We need a better way to manage changes to documents, software, images, large websites, and other collections of code, configuration, and metadata among disparate teams. (Examples in GitLab include Git, branches, merge requests, code review, InnerSourcing, WebIDE, and files.)

Analyst Coverage: IDC, to some extent, forecasts this market. No spot on, recent reports, though Gartner may be considering a future report.

Value Drivers:

1. Increase Operational Efficiencies: share and reuse code, prevent rework, and make reviews more efficient

1. Deliver Better Products Faster: streamline reviews and collaboration around code changes

1. Reduce Security and Compliance Risk: easier compliance through approvals of code changes

Note: SCM is sold via the web. There is no accompanying Value Play. This conversation should lead the prospect toward the Delivery Automation solution.

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## SECTION: marketing/user-engagement.md

User community engagement is important in creating awareness among various communities who become advocates of GitLab internally at companies down the line or influence others at said companies. Improving our user engagement is one of GitLab's top 12 cross-functional initiatives. The goal is to have a strong developer brand.

The User Engagement initiative has three workstreams:

1. Build brand awareness with thought leadership and technical content to activate members of our community programs (Education, Open Source, Meetups, Heroes) ( active community members).

Public technical content epic

1. Develop, brand and market the DevOps Architect Certification program focused on technical users at our customers and our partners ( of partner and total certifications).

Public certification epic

1. Drive toward 1000 contributors a month using a marketing funnel approach.

Public contributor goal epic

Note: In addition to the public epics above, there are placeholder epics in the confidential top 12 initiatives repository. As our work on this initiative does not require confidentiality, we are not linking to those placeholders.

## Overall Goal

Activate the community and drive them to become more involved in GitLab programs - community programs, certification or contributor programs. Increase contributors to 1000 contributors per month.

## DRI

The current DRI for this initiative is GitLab's Manager, Developer Evangelism. The executive sponsor is the CMO.

## Stakeholders

There are numerous stakeholders working on this initiative including:

- Quality Engineering
- Content Marketing
- Customer Success
- Field Enablement
- Developer Relations

## How we work

## GitLab

Work being done on this initiative can be found in the gitlab-com group. The issues, epics, and merge requests associated with this work are labeled with the User engagement label.

## Strategy Doc

The overall strategy doc for reaching our contributor goal can be found in Google Drive by searching for Strategy to increase 10x Community Contributors. This work is also broken out into epics in the Quality project.

## Slack

The Slack channel for this initiative is wguser-engagement.

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## SECTION: marketing/utm-strategy.md

## Overview

The purpose of this handbook page is to outline how our UTM strategy drives insightful dashboards in Sisense. You may learn how to use the UTM builder, and why it is critical that we

use this consistent process across all marketing channels for consistent and useful reporting.

Enablement Session] Iteration & Review of UTM Parameters available in [this YouTube video, and ppt presentation.

Everyone can contribute - See something you'd like to discuss or iterate on? Start an MR and post it in mktg-analytics slack channel.

## What are UTMs

UTM parameters are specific text strings appended to the URLs, used to facilitate performance tracking in Tableau dashboards through Bizible Touchpoints & other web analytics tools.

Example url:

text

<https://page.gitlab.com/resources-ebook-beginners-guide-devops-fr.html?utmmedium=email&utmsource=marketo&utmcampaign=20240120emeadmpwebcastautosdfrbeginnersguidedevops&utmcontent=devguideappsecebook&utmpartnerid=gcp>

The UTM parameters are everything that comes after the question mark:

utmmedium=email  
utmsource=marketo  
utmcampaign=20240120emeadmpwebcastautosdfrbeginnersguidedevops  
utmcontent=devguideappsecebook  
utmpartnerid=0018X00002zWCjU

## Why use UTMs

Adding UTMs to links allows Marketing to identify the source of traffic, form fills and activity on our web properties, creating the first step in the marketing funnel. When our web traffic and form fills have sources, Marketing can use attribution methods to calculate the ROI.

UTM parameters provide three key benefits:

1. Help us understand our customers' journey through each touchpoint.
2. Provides us with the marketing channel and marketing campaign categorization, plus the landing page the person converted on telling us the offer (webinar, gated content, free trial etc.).
3. Used in combination, we can better understand what mix of marketing channels, campaigns, and offers produce the best results.

## When to use UTMs

Understanding when UTMs are needed and not needed on links is important for keeping our marketing data clean and useful. As a general rule, when a link directs to a website GitLab controls, UTMs should be added to the link.

There are a couple situations when UTMs are not needed and can break tracking. The most common is when linking to another page on the same website. For example, if a campaign directs traffic to a landing page on [pages.gitlab.com](https://pages.gitlab.com) and the landing page links to another page on the same domain, only the landing page needs UTMs on the links.

UTMs should always be used when linking to:

[about.gitlab.com](https://about.gitlab.com)  
[gitlab.com](https://gitlab.com) (trial and registration pages only)  
[learn.gitlab.com](https://learn.gitlab.com)  
[pages.gitlab.com](https://pages.gitlab.com)  
[docs.gitlab.com](https://docs.gitlab.com)

When UTMs are NOT Needed:

When linking to a non GitLab web property (Eg: Youtube, LinkedIn, etc..)  
Internal links with the same [gitlab.com](https://gitlab.com) domain. For instance, linking to [learn.gitlab.com](https://learn.gitlab.com) from an [about.gitlab.com](https://about.gitlab.com) webpage. Google Analytics is set up for cross-domain tracking. If UTMs are detected within an internal [gitlab.com](https://gitlab.com) link, a new session will be counted, and conversion attribution will be overridden by the new UTM parameter values. The original source will not receive proper credit.

How to create UTMs

Use the UTM builder googlesheet with formulas. Here is a video overview of the spreadsheet. The process involves the following steps:

Open the Tracking URL Builder

Add in your page URL in the first column

Fill in each attribute of your UTM parameter, including `utmsource`, `utmmedium`, `utmcampaign`, `utmcontent`, `utmbudget`. If some of these UTM parameters are irrelevant to your campaign, keep them blank or remove from the final URL.

Destination URL will be generated automatically in column N, ready for you to use in your campaign. If you need to shorten your URL, use a tool like [bit.ly](https://bit.ly).

Measuring the success

Measure success of your campaign in the TD Campaigns Dashboard under "Bizible Channel Drill Down" or "Regional Campaign Drill Down" sections.

UTM Values

`utmmedium`

Campaign Medium is the overarching channel bucket like email, display, etc. It answers the question of "How did they come to us?". `utmsource` will further categorize the overarching channel.

You can choose a campaign medium from a provided picklist of values in the URL Builder spreadsheet. If you need a new campaign medium, please request this using slack channel: [mktg-strat-perf](#).

Current available options for utmmedium are as follows:

email = all email systems such as marketo, outreach, mailjet, highspot, etc.

cpc = Paid Search

display = Display ads

paidsocial = Paid Social

social = Organic Social

sponsorship = Paid publishers engagements/sponsorships

chat = website conversational bot

pdf links in whitepapers, ebooks, reports, etc.

referral = Customer review sites

syndication = 3rd party - content syndication

webinar = 3rd party - sponsored event

video = 1st party - owned video

utmsource

Campaign Source parameter can tell you which website is sending the traffic, and is a further "slicing" of overall channels. It answers the question of "how did they come to us?" but with more granular details than utmmedium.

You can choose a campaign source from a provided picklist of values in the URL Builder spreadsheet. If you need a new campaign source, please request this using slack channel: mktg-strat-perf.

Current available options for utmsource are as follows:

| Source         | Lines up with Medium                                               | Source           | Lines up with Medium                                             |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| adwords        | lines up with cpc                                                  | marketo          | lines up with email, sent through Marketo (marketing automation) |
| bing           | lines up with cpc                                                  | mailjet          | lines up with email, essentially sent through product            |
| yahoo          | lines up with cpc                                                  | trustradius      | lines up with referral                                           |
| doubleclick    | lines up with display                                              | highspot         | lines up with email, sent through highspot (Sales)               |
| 6sense         | lines up with display                                              | gmail            | lines up with display                                            |
| google         | lines up with organic search, cpc, and display                     | outreach         | lines up with email, sent through Outreach (SDR/BDR)             |
| demandbase     | lines up with display                                              | g2               | lines up with referral                                           |
| facebook       | lines up with organic social and paid social                       | gartnerdigital   | lines up with referral                                           |
| linkedin       | lines up with paidsocial, social                                   | gartnerpeer      | lines up with referral                                           |
| twitter        | lines up with paidsocial, social                                   | integrate-market | lines up with syndication                                        |
| iterable       | lines up with email, sent through Iterable (marketing) for product | youtube          | should appear in dropdown menu for "video"                       |
| stack-overflow | lines up with display                                              | vimeo            | should appear in dropdown menu for "video"                       |



|  
| agency | lines up with email, paid social, social (depends how the agency is promoting) | | |

Values for utmsource are available as an open picklist in the UTM builder googlesheet. Please be consistent when adding new values to the list, keeping the best practice of no characters and all lower case.

The new utmcampaign structure

Instead of a single value for UTM Campaign, it will encode many values into a single parameter: DateRegionBudgetTypepgtm[Language][campaignname]

Encoding more data on the UTM campaign directly transfers that information to Bizible touchpoints and allows for drop-down / point and click reporting in SFDC.

| Parameter                        | Required / Optional                   | Examples                                      |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Date (in ISO format - yyyyymmdd) | Yes (if campaign is evergreen use eg) | 20240220                                      |
| Region (select from dropdown)    | Yes (if multi regions, use x)         | emea                                          |
| Budget (select from dropdown)    | Yes (if not applicable, use x)        | dmp                                           |
| Type (select from dropdown)      | Yes (if not applicable, use x)        | dmp                                           |
| GTM (select from dropdown)       | Yes (if not applicable, use x)        | autosd                                        |
| Language (select from dropdown)  | Optional                              | fr                                            |
| Campaign name (free text field)  | Optional                              | beginnersguideddevops                         |
| Agency (free text field)         | Optional, rare                        | Name of 3rd party agency if one is being used |

Note on Agency: Sometimes 3rd party agencies are used to drive registrations to events. This is uncommon. If you are using an agency, use the agency source and add the name of the agency to the Agency field in the UTM generator. This will append the name in the appropriate location as part of the utmcampaign value.

Current GTM UTMs

speedsecurity = Trading off Speed for Security  
devsecopsplat = DevSecOps Platform GTM  
autosd = Automated Software Delivery GTM

Retired Use Case UTMs

seccomp = Security and Compliance GTM  
singleappci = CI Campaign  
iacgitops = GitOps Campaign  
vccusecase = VC&C Campaigns (retired)  
competegh = OctoCat Competitive  
cdusecase = CD Campaign

utmcontent

Campaign Content (utmcontent) is an optional parameter which encodes two values - content offer and asset type:

| Parameter           | Required / Optional                 | Examples       |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------|
| Content offer       | Optional (if not applicable, use x) | devguideappsec |
| Asset type          | Optional (if not applicable, use x) | ebook          |
| Industry (vertical) | Optional (if not applicable, use x) | telco          |

Example: utmcontent=seccspackageebookfs

Asset Type values (available as picklist in the UTM builder googlesheet):

ebook = Gated ebooks  
 whitepaper = Whitepapers  
 blog = Blog posts  
 video = Video content  
 briefs = Solutions Briefs  
 infogr = Infographic

utmpartnerid

The UTM parameter URL plays a huge part on partner lead routing and reporting. We utilize utmpartnerid in the UTM parameter URL to capture the Account ID (18) of the Partner Account, which populates into the CRM Partner ID. This process is embedded as a hidden field in all our partner-related Marketo forms. Each page must have the utmpartnerid in the URL, otherwise we cannot pass to the partner.

utmmedium = partner (never changes)  
 utmsoure = partner (never changes)  
 GTM = x (never changes)

Partner Name - utmpartnerid is a dropdown show all Channel Partners, and two Alliance Partners (AWS, and GCP). Select the partner you are working with.

Fill out the rest of the UTM parameters

UTM structure for nurture emails

UTM Medium = email (never changes)  
 UTM Source = marketo (never changes)  
 UTM campaign = DateRegionBudgetTypeegtm[Language][campaignname] (i.e. 20240220emeadmpwebcastdevsecopsplatfrbeginnersguidedevops)  
 UTM content = contentoffer and asset type (i.e. utmcontent=devguideappsecebook)  
 Do not use nurture for utmcontent.

UTM structure for account based marketing

UTM structure for 6Sense

UTM Medium = banner  
 UTM Source = 6sense  
 See utmcampaign for accepted options.

For ad variations, use shorthand addition (i.e. -accl1 -accel2) to the end of the content

option

Example in practice: utmcontent=acceldigtransformation would add the following for 4 ad variations with different ad copy:

utmcontent=acceldigtransformation-accel2  
utmcontent=acceldigtransformation-accel1  
utmcontent=acceldigtransformation-live2  
utmcontent=acceldigtransformation-live1

---

## SECTION: marketing/account-based-marketing/\_index.md

Overview

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

ABM is a marketing strategy that concentrates resources on a set of target accounts. We create personalized campaigns designed to engage small cohorts of accounts based on specific attributes and needs of the accounts (ex. industry, competitive take out, etc.). The ultimate goal is for ABM to align with teams across Marketing and Sales to work in tandem to create personalized buying experiences for a mutually-identified set of high-value accounts · the goal for which is increased deal velocity and pipeline. Attainment of our KPIs and goals is a collaborative effort across interlocking teams.

Team Structure

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

- Marci Geisler - Senior Account Based Marketing Manager, ENT & MM for APAC and EMEA
- Megan O'Dowd - Senior Account Based Marketing Manager, ENT & MM for AMER and US Public Sector

ABM Platform: 6sense

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

We are the owners of the ABM platform, 6sense at GitLab. 6sense is an Account Based Marketing platform that uses a predictive model to identify the right customers at the ideal time. We use 6sense to build our target account lists, launch display advertising, and measure account progression through the sales funnel over time. 6sense also provides account intelligence on things like intent, engagement, and keyword search. There is a 6sense data section on the account in Salesforce that is available for our XDR org and coming soon to the Sales org. If you have any questions about the tool or access to it, please drop a slack in 6sensehelp.

FY25 Strategy

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Epic link coming soon..

ABM Key Account List

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Our key account list consists of Mid-Market and Enterprise accounts that the sales/XDR org are also heavily focusing on as denoted by the Account Rank field on accounts in Salesforce. Specifically, Rank 1-2.

## ABM Tactics

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

### - LinkedIn Sponsored Content

- Sponsored ads: Sponsored Content allows us to publish ads in the LinkedIn newsfeed across both desktop and mobile. We can target a specific audience of people which helps us raise awareness and drive quality leads.

- Display Advertising: Mobile and desktop advertisements served to a specific audience on a specific list of websites. These are launched through our ABM platform, 6sense.

- Qualified: a chat platform to engage visitors on our webpages

- Reachdesk: a global gifting platform

- Terminus Email Signature Banners: Ads within an email signature that are targeted based on email address domain.

### - Pathfactory:

- Content tracks: Allow us to bundle assets together (around 5-7) in a "content track" and shared as one link. Instead of sharing multiple links to individual assets, one link provides a curated content experience.

- Microsites: PathFactory's Microsite Builder enables us to display multiple types of Content Tracks within a custom-designed landing page that aligns to our Tier 1 accounts or a Tier 2 cohort of accounts.

## Communication

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Our slack channel abmteam is used for team updates and quick questions.

For questions about 6sense, our ABM platform, use the slack channel 6sensehelp

## Project Management

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

ABM works out of the GitLab project: Account Based Marketing within the larger Marketing project.

## Team labels

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

- ABM: DRI is in ABM team. Alerts the ABM team that an issue has been opened for triage.

- 6sense: any issues that are related to Demandbase ABM campaigns

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## SECTION: marketing/blog/\_index.md

Welcome to the GitLab Blog handbook! The GitLab Blog is managed by the Content Marketing team. The managing editor of the blog is Sandra Gittlen (@sgittlen).

What is a blog post?

At GitLab, blog posts largely focus on sharing helpful information with the audience (DevSecOps professionals). When you suggest or write a blog post, always consider what it offers the reader. If the post is more internal-focused or a personal essay of sorts, it is likely not a fit for the blog (but could go on your personal LinkedIn page).

Blogs fall into the following categories:

- Technical tutorials/how-tos
- Point of view/thought leadership
- Introduction to features and capabilities
- Open source community
- Customer case studies/interviews
- Company announcement (done in partnership with Executive comms team)
- Feature/change/etc. announcement
- Guest blog to highlight partnerships/alliances

Who can publish content to the GitLab Blog?

Everyone can contribute at GitLab. For the blog, this means we welcome your blog suggestions, ideas, and drafts. However, the main blog is one of the many official voices of GitLab · meaning content that is published there must be carefully vetted to ensure we are accurately representing GitLab · both the company and the product. The Blog Managing Editor and the Director of Global Content Marketing are the directly responsible individuals (DRIs) for the official GitLab blog and are tasked with this responsibility.

If you have questions about the GitLab Blog, please reach out to [sgittlen@gitlab.com](mailto:sgittlen@gitlab.com).

How to suggest a blog idea - NEW PROCESS {how-to-suggest-a-blog-post}

Please create an issue using the blog submission template.

- Answer all the questions on the template. They help us provide feedback on your idea.
- Submit your idea at least two weeks before your targeted publication date.
- For corporate/comms requests or blogs on a tight turnaround, please submit an issue and reach out to @sgittlen directly.

The blog editor will review the pitch and either a) greenlight the post, b) offer suggestions for improvements, or c) explain why the idea might not be a fit for the blog and offer other ideas for getting the message out.

Note: You can also notify the Blog team of a typo or request a change via the blog submission template.

External contributions

Note: GitLab does not accept unsolicited blog submissions. If you are a GitLab partner and would like to pitch a blog post idea for consideration, please email [sgittlen@gitlab.com](mailto:sgittlen@gitlab.com). If you are a GitLab community member and would like to pitch a blog post idea for consideration, please email [contributors@gitlab.com](mailto:contributors@gitlab.com). Please DO NOT SEND drafts of your blogs with your pitch.

Pitch ideas must be relevant to the GitLab Blog and our readers and include the following information:

- What will your blog be about? Please be as specific as possible.
- Which of the following best describes your blog? (Please check at least one box.)
- ☐ tutorial/how-to on how best to use a feature/capability
- ☐ best practices for how to use the GitLab platform
- ☐ the open source community and GitLab
- ☐ partner/alliance integration
- ☐ other - please explain

All blog pitch ideas and submissions will be vetted and reviewed by GitLab team members.

Blog editors, please add the following two sentences at the beginning of contributed articles:

Editor's note: From time to time, we invite members of the community to contribute to the GitLab Blog. Thanks to [entity name] for co-creating with us.

External contributions are subject to the External Blog Submissions Terms. Please read this document and agree to terms before submitting material to GitLab.

How to submit a blog draft once your idea is approved

Once a blog pitch is approved, the author will use the Blog Submission template (Google Doc) to write the blog, ensuring the Google Doc is linked in the issue. All fields in the template will have to be completed for the blog team to accept the submission.

The author will tag @sgittlen in the issue, put the doc link in a comment, and share the Google Doc once it is ready to be edited (after all necessary approvals and reviews have been completed). Note: All images must be included inline in the Google Doc.

Note: All blog submissions now require a call to action or CTA and you will be asked to provide one in the blog draft template. A CTA is what you want the reader to do next after reading your blog. Do you want them to go to another page and learn more, sign up for a trial, register for a webinar, view a demo, etc.? We will be able to track the CTA as part of our overall blog metrics.

The blog edit process

The blog team will communicate initial edits/questions for the author using the issue and Google Doc. The blog team will then put the blog into the CMS and, if necessary, share a preview link with the author/DRI. Note: The blog will be published from Contentful.

If changes are needed post-publication, the author will reach out to the blog team via Slack

and explain the change. Note: We can no longer use MRs for changes/updates.

The blog team will share the blog's URL with the author once it is published.

Publishing of blog posts occurs according to an editorial calendar. However, that is subject to change based on blogs that are urgent. The blog team will update authors as to their expected publish dates.

#### Legal review process

Some blog posts must be reviewed by legal, in accordance with our Materials Legal Review Process/SAFE program. Authors are responsible for reviewing SAFE guidelines and getting Legal approval before sharing the Google Doc with the blog team. This process can take time, so please plan target publication dates accordingly.

GitLab has a bias for action, and the Blog team is no different. However, the GitLab Blog is a public-facing asset and represents the company. If the Blog team has concerns or questions about the information contained in the blog post, the Blog team has the authority to hold a blog post until Legal, Corporate Communications, Partner Marketing, the CMO, etc., can review the blog post to mitigate any potential risk for the company.

Learn more about the SAFE Guidelines by reading the handbook page and following the Materials Legal Review Process.

#### How to suggest a change to a published blog

If you are internal to GitLab and want to suggest a change to a published GitLab blog, please post the change you need in detail with the URI in the content Slack channel and tag @sgittlen or ping @sgittlen directly in Slack.

If you are external to GitLab, please email Sandra Gittlen at [sgittlen@gitlab.com](mailto:sgittlen@gitlab.com) with the details of your suggested change.

#### Communication with Blog team

Chat channels:

- Use content for questions (also tag @sgittlen)
- Use content-updates to see updates on recently published articles
- Slack @sgittlen directly
- Add newsletter content requests to this issue

#### Other related pages

- Editorial style guide
- Brand guidelines
- Monthly release post

#### Considerations when drafting a blog

## Diversity, Inclusion, and Belonging (DIB) checklist for blog writers

It is important that our blog content represents our company values of diversity, inclusion, and belonging. Not all of these points will be relevant to your blog post, but they are important values and practices to be mindful of throughout the writing process. The blog editorial team tries to check for these things, but it is better if all content is created with these values and practices in mind. Tag us or a member of the DIB team if you have questions!

### Inclusive formatting

- Did you select an inclusive cover image and/or screengrab?
- Write descriptive alternative text for all inline images and screengrabs. Alternative text is important for SEO and accessibility. Read this article from Moz to learn more about writing alternative text.
- Ensure that all links are meaningful and descriptive (e.g. avoid link text such as "read here" or "this article"). Descriptive links are more useful and accessible for people using screen readers.

### Inclusive writing

- Write short and concise sentences. Clear writing with short sentences makes it easier for the reader to follow along.
- Limit your use of jargon, and if you must use a jargon-y term, define it on the first instance.
- GitLab is a global team with a global community, so you want to write for a global audience. This means limiting your use of regional metaphors and not writing in a manner that is United States-centric.
- Does the post use inclusive language?
- Is every individual in the blog post quoted using their preferred pronoun? Tip: If you don't know someone's preferred pronoun, just ask them. They should also be included on the team page profile and Slack profile.

### More DIB writing tips

- Is your blog post biased? We all have unconscious biases. Check the list of unconscious biases in our DIB handbook page and practice strategies for recognizing and managing yours.
- If you still have questions, don't hesitate to tag the editorial team lead @sgittlen, leads of the appropriate team member resource group (TMRG) in your blog issue, or email [diversityinclusionandbelonging@gitlab.com](mailto:diversityinclusionandbelonging@gitlab.com) with your questions.

### Blog categories and tags

#### Categories

Use only one of the following categories per post.  
Do not change the capitalization, spelling, or anything else, otherwise you'll create another category, which is something we don't want to do accidentally.

If you're not sure which category your post belongs in, just put a placeholder in your MR and leave a comment for your reviewer noting that.



- agile planning - posts about Agile planning
- ai-ml - posts that focus directly on AI/ML in the platform or in the industry as a whole
- customer stories - posts about how our customers are using GitLab DevSecOps platform
- DevSecOps - posts more generally about DevSecOps
- engineering - technical, actionable content. Anything covering how to do something, use something, or solve a problem should fall under this category
- open source - stories from or about our community, users, or the wider open source community
- product - details about features, roadmaps, and strategy
- news - company or product announcements (including policy changes, operational announcements, and breaking changes), news, or events
- security - security-related posts
- releases - release posts, security and patch releases. Posts in the releases category need to be in the `sites/uncategorized/source/releases/posts` directory, not `sites/uncategorized/source/blog/blog-posts`. Please see the Release Post handbook for more.

## Tags

These are included to help readers find similar posts if they are interested in a particular subject. Tags appear at the top of each blog post, and clicking on a tag takes you to the specific `/blog/tags/specific-tag` where you can view all posts with the specified tag.

You can include as many tags as you like, separated by commas. Please only include tags from the following list, and note that they are case sensitive.

- agile
- AI/ML
- automotive
- AWS
- bug bounty
- careers
- CI
- CD
- CI/CD
- cloud native
- code review
- collaboration
- community
- contributors
- customers
- demo
- design
- developer survey
- DevSecOps
- DevSecOps platform
- education (articles about the education sector)
- events
- features
- financial services
- frontend
- git

- GitOps
- GKE
- google
- growth
- inside GitLab
- integrations
- kubernetes
- news
- open source
- partners
- patch releases
- performance
- product
- production
- public sector
- releases
- remote work
- research
- security
- security releases
- security research
- solutions architecture
- startups
- testing
- tutorial
- UI
- user stories
- UX
- webcast
- workflow
- zero trust

## Media embeds

We limit media embeds to the following providers:

- YouTube for video
- CodePen for code samples
- Google Docs for collaborative text
- Google Sheets for sharing spreadsheets
- Google Slides for sharing slides

## Adding code blocks

Below are the two types of code blocks we commonly use on the blog. Find a number of other options in the Markdown guide.

### Inline code

We use this for short words or phrases included in a paragraph. For inline code, surround the

word or code with single backticks ( ).

Example:

This is an in-line code block.

Results in:

This is an in-line code block.

Fenced code blocks

"Fenced" code blocks look like the block below. We use these for longer code snippets. To create a fenced code block, put triple backticks on one line directly above and one line directly below the code.

```
text
this is my code block
  here's another line
end
```

Highlighted code

Syntax highlighting helps make code easier to read. In order to enable syntax highlighting please append the language type at the end of the code block. The name matters because every language is highlighted differently.

Example (not highlighted):

```
markdown
code goes here
```

```
js
document.querySelectorAll('a[href^=""]').forEach(elem => {
  elem.addEventListener('click', e => {
    e.preventDefault();
    let block = document.querySelector(elem.getAttribute('href')),
        offset = elem.dataset.offset ? parseInt(elem.dataset.offset) : 0,
        bodyOffset = document.body.getBoundingClientRect().top;
    window.scrollTo({
      top: block.getBoundingClientRect().top - bodyOffset + offset,
      behavior: "smooth"
    });
  });
});
```

Versus (highlighted javascript):

markdown  
code goes herejavascript

(or other languages/syntaxes such as yaml, ruby, sql, etc)

```
javascript
document.querySelectorAll('a[href^=""]').forEach(elem => {
  elem.addEventListener('click', e => {
    e.preventDefault();
    let block = document.querySelector(elem.getAttribute('href')),
        offset = elem.dataset.offset ? parseInt(elem.dataset.offset) : 0,
        bodyOffset = document.body.getBoundingClientRect().top;
    window.scrollTo({
      top: block.getBoundingClientRect().top - bodyOffset + offset,
      behavior: "smooth"
    });
  });
});
```

## Mermaid charts

Details about how to embed mermaid charts into your blog can be found in this MR. Please read as there are nuances that might prevent your chart from rendering properly.

## Preparing images

- If creating an original cover image, the dimensions should be 1800px x 945px for optimal quality on all displays.
- All images should aim to be less than 1MB. JPEGs tend to be smaller than PNGs so use JPEGs when possible.
- To resize in Preview go to Tools, Adjust size and adjust the entry in the Resolution field. Preview will estimate what the resulting image size will be before you click OK to confirm.
- Keep all the images the same width.

## Screenshots

For technical/tutorial posts, please illustrate your examples with code blocks or screenshots. Be consistent with your examples. E.g., if you are using a generic URL to exemplify your steps domain.com, be consistent and keep it domain.com, throughout the post.

- Static images should be used to illustrate concepts, provide diagrams, elements of the UI or orient the reader.
- Images should not be used to render commands or configuration which would prevent someone being able to copy and paste.
- Animated GIFs can be used sparingly where you need to show a process or some event happening over the course of time or several actions, though they should not replace text descriptions or instructions.
- Use screenshots to identify and localize specific parts of the screen. There are great tools

for doing so. For example, Nimbus Screenshot (browser extension), Mac screenshot, Snipping Tool for Windows, and Screenshot Tool for Ubuntu.

Important security point: Do not expose your personal details by using your real tokens or security credentials. Use placeholders such as [project's CI token] stub instead. Or blur them if displayed on screenshots.

### Embedding videos

Please see the Markdown Guide for instructions for embedding videos from YouTube and other sources.

### Embedding tweets or Instagram posts

Please see the Markdown guide for instructions for embedding posts from social media.

### Creating GIFs

Animated GIFs are very useful to illustrate short dynamic processes, which might be easier to understand with this kind of resource.

There are a few ways to create animated GIFs, one of them is using [Giphy Capture], a light-weight app for Mac.

Avoid GIFs with a huge file size, they will be difficult to load for users with bad internet connection. In those cases, you can either cut the GIFs in smaller pieces, or record a video, or use a sequential image.

### Creating Author entries in the CMS

Here's a set of recommendations when creating an Author entry in the CMS.

#### - Name field

This is a required field. It is also a unique field.

1. Author's name should be a combination of first and last name only, including composed names. Please avoid adding a job description (use the Role field for this task) or alpha-numeric combinations into this field.

1. No double authors (eg. /authors/<author1>-<author2>). We can add multiple single authors to blog posts. We should create individual authors and then add them all to other content types as a one-to-many relationship.

1. Same as above, no multiple authors for a single blog post (eg. /authors/<author1>-<author2>-<author3>-and-<author4>).

#### - Role field

Current working position or job description.

#### - Bio field

Biography of the Author.

## - GitLab handle field

It corresponds to Author's GitLab username in lowercase format. This field has to be unique.

## - Social media handles fields

Optional fields for social media handles.

## Localizing blog posts in Contentful

We can publish blog posts in languages other than English. We currently support the following languages:

| Language | URL structure                     |
|----------|-----------------------------------|
| French   | /fr-fr/blog/YEAR/MONTH/DAY/Title/ |
| German   | /de-de/blog/YEAR/MONTH/DAY/Title/ |
| Japanese | /ja-jp/blog/YEAR/MONTH/DAY/Title/ |

## Translating an English-language blog post to other languages

Translating an English-language blog post into another language is straightforward. Contentful offers a feature called "Field level localization," which allows us to specify the fields on the blog post that we want to translate. In the right-hand navigation while on a blog post, there's a "Localization" section. By selecting locales in that section, we can show or hide localized fields based on the currently selected locales. Once these fields have been completed, simply click "Publish" and the changes will go live on production in approximately five minutes.

It's important to note that while we wait for Contentful to release locale-specific publishing (Spring 2024), any draft content, regardless of language, will also be published.

## Publishing a blog post with no English-language equivalent

Publishing a blog post without an English-language equivalent follows the same process as "Translating an English blog post to other languages" with one minor difference. Contentful mandates that required fields cannot be left empty in English. To circumvent this requirement, a " " character can be inserted into the English Title and Blog Body fields. This informs our system that the English-language blog post does not exist and should not generate a web page for it.

Contentful is currently developing a solution to address this workaround, which is expected to be available by Fall 2024.

## How to kick off translations

Starting the process of getting a blog post translated is easy. Follow these steps:

1. Create a translation request issue in the Localization project. Pro tip - add the URL for

the blog post and a direct link to the Contentful entry. It will be super helpful to you as you track the project.

2. Argo will export the English blog post as JSON and import the translated JSON back into Contentful. Then you'll be pinged in the issue when it's ready for review.
3. Hop into the entry for the blog post and review the translated content.
4. Coordinate with @sgittlen on publishing the translated post.
5. Once published, always verify that it's working as expected on [about.gitlab.com/blog/](https://about.gitlab.com/blog/).
6. Celebrate your translated blog post by posting it in Slack.

Here's a video walkthrough of the full process from creating the translation request to publishing on production.

- Video recording coming soon that demonstrates the following
- Create issue
- Argo roundtrip
- Translation show up in Contentful
- Review the translations
- Live previews/changing languages
- Publish

Gotchas When Localizing an EN blog post

Things to be careful about when localizing an EN blog post.

- Don't change the slug!

Tags to keep organized

- If a post